PUNE, WEDNESDAY, SEPTEMBER 9, 2026

Pune Times Mirror

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16 Pages Invitation PRICE Rs 5

MAX 29 | MIN 21 | HUMIDITY 66%

VOLUME NO 13, ISSUE NO 211 | RNI NO. MAHENG/2014/55530

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The Katraj zoo authorities arranged water coolers for animals in April and May, when the maximum temperature had shot up



The photo above, taken by activists during summer and submitted to the MHRC, shows inmates without fans, let alone coolers at the Yerwada mental hospital

Even zoo conditions are better than Yerwada mental hospital: Activist

WORSE THAN BEASTLY TREATMENT?

Rights panel summons Disability Commissioner

Landmark first hearing scheduled for today

Vijay Chavan
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Imagine enduring punishing 40 to 45 degree Celsius summer heat with blistering heat frying your skin, trapped underneath searing iron-sheet roofs. Now, add severe psychiatric distress, absolute helplessness, and a suffocating ward devoid of even a functioning ceiling fan or a breath of fresh air. This chilling reality inside the Regional Mental Hospital (RMC), Yerwada, has been brought to the notice of the Maharashtra State Human Rights Commission (MSHRC) by Pune activist Shashikant Ulhas Satote.

"While the Rajiv Gandhi Zoological Park in Katraj pulls out all the stops to ensure advanced cooling systems for wild animals, vulnerable psychiatric patients languish in sweltering wards at the RMC," Satote has stated in his complaint application with MHRC, seeking action for gross human rights violations.

CONTINUED ON PAGE 4 >>

Sensex closes 555 points down, Nifty loses 0.61%

Indian benchmark indices closed lower on Tuesday, weighed down by rising crude oil prices as Brent crude neared the $100 per barrel mark. The BSE Sensex closed at 75,577.58, down 555.23 points, or 0.73 per cent, while the Nifty 50 index settled at 23,635.10, declining 144.05 points, or 0.61 per cent.

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Light rain for four days

Slight rise in rainfall activity during Ganesh festival, says IMD

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PHOTO: SWAPNIL JAWALE

The sky was overcast in the city on Tuesday, with some areas receiving light showers

The India Meteorological Department has forecast light showers during the Ganesh festival in the city, and conditions are expected to become more favourable for rain in the middle of September. On Tuesday, various parts of the city saw brief spells of rain.

According to the IMD, the skies are likely to be partly cloudy in the city and neighbouring areas from September 9 to 12.

Very light to light rain is expected on September 9, 10 and 11, while similar rainfall activity is likely on September 12. Maximum temperatures will be 30-31 degrees Celsius and the minimum temperatures are expected to stay between 20 and 23 degrees Celsius.

The weather pattern is expected to slightly change from September 13, when the IMD forecast points to generally cloudy skies and the possibility of light to moderate rain. The forecast for September 14 also indicates light to moderate rainfall, suggesting an increase in rain activity over Pune.

According to weather experts, conditions could become more favourable for rainfall over interior Maharashtra from September 13, with Pune likely to see increased rainfall activity from September 14. The forecast is based on model guidance, including the IMD-GFS model.

Former IMD official and meteorologist K S Hosalikar, in a post on X, shared the ECMWF model guidance for rainfall anomalies during the three weeks from September 7 to 28. He said that the monsoon could become more active in parts of central India, including Maharashtra, from September 14 onwards.

"Parts of central India including Maharashtra could get busy in action from the 14th onwards," Hosalikar said while sharing the model guidance.

The latest forecast suggests that Pune may see a gradual build-up in rainfall rather than an immediate spell of heavy rain. While the September 9-12 outlook points mainly to very light to light rain, the possibility of light to moderate rain from September 13-14 indicates a shift towards more active monsoon conditions.

The forecast comes as the city prepares for the Ganesh festival, when large numbers of devotees are expected to participate in processions and public celebrations.

The expected rainfall activity could therefore bring some relief from the prevailing dry and hot conditions, but may also affect outdoor events and traffic movement.

PHOTOS: SWAPNIL JAWALE









CHOWK-A-BLOC!

Traffic jams are a daily affair at Gunjan Chowk in Yerwada due to the ongoing pipeline work. Serpentine queues of vehicles during peak hours at the busy junction slows down traffic and increases commuting time. While the pipeline project may be necessary for the city's infrastructure development, the vehicular congestion highlights the need for better traffic management and safer movement around major roadwork zones.

EDITORIAL

MIRROR REFLECTS

Write to him at rajendra.masur@punetimesmirror.com

A jinxed project?

Anger and frustration mount over delays in Pune Metro Line 3 opening

Punekars are frustrated over the delay in the inauguration of the first stretch of Pune Metro Line 3. The Commissioner of Metro Rail Safety had given clearance for the section between Balewadi and Maan in July. It was expected that services will begin soon but the hopes of citizens have been dashed due to the never ending delay in the inauguration.

The 23.3-km Line 3 is being developed by the Pune Metropolitan Region Development Authority (PMRDA) to provide a direct public transport link between Hinjawadi and Shivajinagar via Balewadi.

The Hinjewadi–Shivajinagar Metro Line 3 project was approved in 2017 and is being developed under a public-private partnership model. The project is being executed by Pune IT City Metro Rail Limited (PITCMRL), a joint venture involving the Tata Group, Siemens and PMRDA.

The corridor is being developed at an estimated cost of around Rs 8,000 crore. Once operational, the Metro will be operated and maintained by Keolis under a 35-year concession agreement.

The construction began many years ago and the project has now entered its final stage. It was recently reviewed by local politicians, along with contractors and engineering partners, including Tata and Siemens.

Thousands of software engineers commute from various parts of the city to Hinjawadi, and face many difficulties as the road is in bad shape. There are massive traffic jams which make commuting a nightmare. Options like bus services and car pooling are being used by techies to reach their offices at Rajiv Gandhi Infotech Park.

Since the project was announced, it was a ray of hope for those who travel to the information technology hub every day. They thought that their misery would end with the starting of the new metro line, and they will be able be to save time and money spent on daily commuting.

But they are a disappointed lot as the deadline for the inaugurations have been regularly postponed. The project was going to be inaugurated in March 2025 but it did not happen. Many deadlines were set but the opening was always postponed.

Citizens are unable to understand why a project which was started many years ago has not been completed and inaugurated. On an average, a metro project is completed within four years. However, even after five years have passed since the construction began, this project is yet to be completed.

The Commissioner of Metro Rail Safety had carried out a detailed inspection and a clearance had been received for the operations to begin on the first phase two months ago.

It was announced by Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis recently that Prime Minister Narendra Modi has been requested to inaugurate the first phase. Is it necessary that important projects should be inaugurated by the PM or CMs? Is it that the ruling party wants to claim credit for executing the project to score political points over its rivals?

The culture of inviting VIPs to open key projects should be done away with. The convenience of the common man should be given top most priority.

There has been an outpouring of anger on the social media regarding the project. There is also a talk whether the project is jinxed and whether it will be 'really' opened for the public. The authorities should not take the common man for granted.

— RAJENDRA MASUR

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WORSE THAN BEASTLY TREATMENT?



CONTINUED FROM PAGE 1

In a directive issued under Section 13 of the Protection of Human Rights Act, 1993, and Regulations 19 and 24 of the MSHRC Regulations 2001, Judicial Member Justice Swapna Joshi has summoned the Commissioner of Persons with Disabilities, Pune, to appear either in person or through a legally authorised representative to submit a comprehensive written defence. The landmark first hearing is slated for Wednesday, Sept 9.

The Commission has mandated that respondents present exhaustive compliance reports and necessary records, warning that strict ex-parte decisions under the law will follow in case of unexcused absence.

"Deprived of adequate fans, water coolers, and sufficient drinking water, already fragile patients face heightened aggression and severe medical distress in the mental hospital," Satote told Pune Times Mirror. "While even zoo animals get water foggers to beat the heat, mentally-ill patients are left to bake," he added while asking whether human beings are worth less than captive wildlife.

The activist sought to know why hospital inmates are subjected to conditions far worse than captive animals, and whether providing fans, coolers, safe drinking water, and humane living conditions is not the fundamental duty of the administration.

The upcoming hearing is expected to grill the administration on multiple fronts: the actual operational status of basic amenities inside the mental hospital wards, grueling allegations that patients are being forcibly deployed to perform menial cleaning tasks, concrete heat mitigation plans, and the systemic failure to guarantee clean drinking water.

Advocate Sonaji Satote, representing the petitioner, said that every individual undergoing treatment in a mental healthcare facility is first a human being whose safe, dignified and humane care is an inviolable constitutional right.

"If vulnerable patients are indeed being exploited for manual labour like cleaning, such practices must face rigorous legal scrutiny" Adv Satote said. "The total failure to provide fans, coolers, and drinking water during peak summer constitutes a brutal assault on human dignity, for which we will fight until absolute accountability is established."

Responding to a query by Pune Mirror, Dr. Shrinivas Kolod, Medical Superintendent of the Regional Mental Hospital, said that a high-level coordination meeting was convened with Public Works Department (PWD) officials on Monday to find out immediate remedial measures.

"Patient care is administered according to individual clinical requirements prescribed by psychiatrists. Coolers and other upgraded amenities will soon be deployed via Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) channels," he added.

As the legal showdown unfolds, the spotlight remains firmly fixed on administrative accountability, raising a timeless, poignant question: In a civilised society, how long must the most vulnerable wait to be treated with human dignity?

MAHARASHTRA KRISHNA VALLEY DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION, PUNE

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Online electronic bids for below mentioned works are invited by The Executive Engineer, Chaskaman Irrigation Division, New Administrative Building, A-Wing, 4th Floor, Pun-411001, Water Resources Department Govt. of Maharashtra on behalf of Governor of State of Maharashtra, Inviting bids through E-tender system (online) In the works shown below from Competent Contractor of Tender documents should be downloaded from the Government website https://mahatenders.gov.in Detailed Tender Notice and information regarding e-Tendering is available on the Government website and on the Notice board of Divisional office.

Executive Engineer, Chaskaman Irrigation Division. Pune reserves the power to accept or reject tenders. Conditional tender will not be accepted. If there is any change in the said tender notification, it will be informed on the website https://mahatenders.gov.in and the notice board of the Division Office.

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District:	Pune
Cost Put to Tender:	Rs. 739.30 In lakhs
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E-tender Opening Date:	Date. 25/09/2026 (if possible)

Outward No:- CID/AB/Tender/3008/2026

Date : 25/08/2026

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Executive Engineer
Chaskaman Irrigation Division, Pune-01

क्रमांक : आरओसी-2026-27/क्र-5/C2703

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निविदा जाहिरात - नविन कामे

विक्री कालावधी दिनांक : दि. ०९/०९/२०२६ १५:०० दुपारी ते १८/०९/२०२६ १५:०० दुपारी पर्यंत

स्विकृती दिनांक : दि. ०९/०९/२०२६ १५:०० दुपारी ते १८/०९/२०२६ १५:०० दुपारी पर्यंत **तांत्रिक निविदा उघडणे प्रक्रिया दिनांक : २१/०९/२०२६ १५.०० दुपारी**

निविदा क्रमांक	खात्याचे नाव	कामाचे नाव	निविदा संच किंमत रू.	अंदाजित पूर्व गणित रक्कम रू.	बयाणा रक्कम रू.	कामाची मुदत (महिने)	निविदा विषयक जबाबदार व्यक्तीचे नाव व दूरध्वनी क्रमांक
PMC/ DRAINAGE/2026/48	मलनि:सारण देखभाल व दुरूस्ती	प्रभाग क्र. २२ मधील भगवा चौक पाठीमागे व गुलटेकडी परिसरात ड्रेनेज लाईन टाकणे व कॉंक्रीट करणे.	रु १३५९/-	रु ३४६७३३५/-	रु ३४६७३/-	६	संदीप नरहरी राजूरकर ९६८९९३९६०६
PMC/ DRAINAGE/2026/49	मलनि:सारण देखभाल व दुरूस्ती	प्रभाग क्र. २२ मधील दीपज्योत तरुण मंडळ ते काशेवाडी पोलीस चौकी पर्यंत मोठ्या व्यासाची लाईन टाकणे व दुरुस्ती विषयक कामे करणे	रु १३५९/-	रु २७६२९४९/-	रु २७६२९/-	६	संदीप नरहरी राजूरकर ९६८९९३९६०६
PMC/ DRAINAGE/2026/50	मलनि:सारण देखभाल व दुरूस्ती	झोन क्र. ३ मधील कार्यालय हद्दीतील मलवाहिन्या व पावसाळी वाहिन्या चॅम्पियन मशीनद्वारे सफाई करणे	रु ६०७९/-	रु ६९९८७८१/-	रु ६९९८८/-	१२	रोहन शिवाजी दिवटे ९०९६५३९८९१
PMC/ DRAINAGE/2026/51	मलनि:सारण देखभाल व दुरूस्ती	झोन क्र ४ मधील मास्टर प्लान नुसार मांजरी येथील रंगीचा ओढा लगत ड्रेनेज लाईन विकसित करणे.	रु ६०७९/-	रु ४७८४१०८/-	रु ४७८४१/-	१२	रुषिकेश विठ्ठल सूर्यवंशी ९८९०७५७४६१
PMC/ DRAINAGE/2026/52	मलनि:सारण देखभाल व दुरूस्ती	प्रभाग क्र. १५ मांजरी गाव रेल्वे गेट परिसरात १८ इंची ड्रेनेज टाकणे.	रु १३५९/-	रु २०७५८७७/-	रु २०७५९/-	९	रुषिकेश विठ्ठल सूर्यवंशी ९८९०७५७४६१
PMC/ DRAINAGE/2026/53	मलनि:सारण देखभाल व दुरूस्ती	प्रभाग क्र. १३ मध्ये कै. तुकारामशेठ वाहनतळ परिसरात मोठ्या व्यासाची ड्रेनेज लाईन टाकणे.	रु १३५९/-	रु ३४२८३९७/-	रु ३४२८४/-	१२	आकाश आशोक देंगे ९०६७७६४७६७
PMC/ DRAINAGE/2026/54	मलनि:सारण देखभाल व दुरूस्ती	वनशिव वस्ती ते तळजाई पठार येथे मोठ्या व्यासाची ड्रेनेज लाईन टाकणे.	रु ६०७९/-	रु ४९२८९२८/-	रु ४९२८९/-	६	प्रशांत प्रदीप परदेशी ७७३८०८१७११
PMC/ DRAINAGE/2026/55	मलनि:सारण देखभाल व दुरूस्ती	ट्रेझर पार्क नाला ते दाते बसथांबा पर्यंत नाल्यातून मोठ्या व्यासाची ड्रेनेज लाईन विकसित करणे.	रु ६०७९/-	रु ४९५००८७/-	रु ४९५०१/-	६	प्रशांत प्रदीप परदेशी ७७३८०८१७११

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Sports quota scam widens

Over 1,000 used fake certificates for government jobs: Addl CP Satpute

Tanisha J. Kunden
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Additional Commissioner of Police (Crime) Tejaswini Satpute addresses a press conference with DCP (Crime) Gauhar Hassan

The investigation has revealed that more than 1,000 fake certificates may have been prepared and sold, allegedly issued to candidates who had never actually participated in Kurash competitions

Addressing a press conference on Tuesday, Additional Commissioner of Police (Crime) Tejaswini Satpute said, "Some of the competitions had taken place, while some had not. We are verifying every certificate to establish which competitions were actually conducted and which were shown only on paper."

The Pune Crime Branch recently busted the racket involving sale of fake Kurash certificates, which it said helped 19 candidates to cheat their way into government jobs, including the police department, under the five percent sports quota, and arrested two office-bearers of the Maharashtra Kurash Association.

The case came to light on September 3, after Pune police registered a case at Shivajinagar police station against Maharashtra Kurash Association secretary Shivaji Jaywant Salunkhe (46) and president Ankush Vitthal Nagar (40). Both were arrested the same day.

Police said the duo allegedly facilitated the issuance of certificates declaring candidates as winners of taluka, district and state-level Kurash competitions, even though several of the competitions listed on the certificates had never actually been conducted.

Kurash, an internationally recognised combat sport, has been officially conducted in Maharashtra through the Maharashtra Kurash Association since 2012. Police suspect the sport's relatively low public awareness was exploited to manufacture and authenticate certificates that could later be used for government recruitment.

Forged signatures, fake umpires

According to police, certificates issued between 2016 and 2023 showed candidates as having participated in or won various competitions. However, discrepancies were found in documents submitted by district-level organisations. The signatures of the association's secretary and president were allegedly used on certificates issued to state-level winners, and police found that representatives of the government sports authority were not present at the events in question.

Investigators further found that individuals lacking the required knowledge or certification had allegedly been appointed as umpires, in place of the national- or international-level referees mandated for such competitions during the period.

Police said the certificates were allegedly sold for amounts ranging from Rs 50,000 to Rs 5 lakh. Investigators are now questioning candidates who obtained the certificates to determine how many knowingly used fraudulent documents, and how many may have been unaware of the alleged malpractice.



Ankush Nagar & Shivaji Salunkhe

Probe widens to government recruitment

The investigation has since widened to examine government recruitment processes. According to information obtained from the Directorate of Sports, 71 candidates have secured jobs in the police and other government departments since 2023 using Kurash certificates under the sports quota. Police are now examining whether the certificates used by these candidates are genuine.

In Pune police recruitment alone, 19 candidates are currently under scrutiny. Of these, 10 are undergoing training with their documents under verification, while the remaining nine are yet to join training, police said.

Investigators are also probing whether fake Kurash certificates were used to obtain the five per cent sports reservation for Class I and Class II posts through the Maharashtra Public Service Commission. The role of government sports officials, and their alleged links with the accused, is also under examination.

Racket may extend beyond Pune

Police suspect the racket may extend beyond Pune, with panchanamas already conducted in Ahilyanagar and Kolhapur as part of the investigation. Officials are also examining the functioning of two rival Kurash associations and a long-standing dispute between them, particularly after a separate association became active from 2016.

"The accused themselves are players. We are investigating who else was involved, to whom the certificates were issued, and the role of organisers, players, agents who allegedly supplied fake certificates, and officials concerned. Both accused have been remanded to judicial custody," Satpute said.

The Crime Branch is conducting a detailed verification of the certificates and recruitment records to establish the full extent of the alleged racket.

132 FIRs against mandals

Noise limit violations during Dahi Handi: Pune records 116 cases, twin-town police book 16 mandals and sound system operators

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Dahi Handi celebrations across Pune and Pimpri-Chinchwad have resulted in 132 FIRs against mandals and sound-system operators for violating permissible noise limits, as police cracked down on organisers who breached restrictions imposed on loudspeaker use during the festivities.

Of the total cases, 116 FIRs were registered in Pune after police recorded sound levels at around 1,100 Dahi Handi celebration spots over the weekend. Meanwhile, in Pimpri-Chinchwad, police registered 16 FIRs against mandals and sound-system operators after compiling data from celebrations held on September 5.

55 cases from old city areas

According to Pune police, the highest number of violations was reported from the old city areas, where 55 cases were registered. Another 27 cases were recorded by police stations along the Pune-Solapur Highway and Hadapsar-Saswad Highway, while 24 cases were registered by police stations along Satara Road.

Deputy Commissioner of Police (Special Branch) Prashant Amrutkar said police had clearly communicated restrictions to mandals ahead of the celebrations and warned them against using prohibited sound equipment. "We seized four plasma and pressure-mid sound system units, besides six other sound systems used by mandals. We banned the use of plasma speakers and pressure-mids. Yet, some mandals used them," Amrutkar said.

During a meeting with mandals' representatives last week, the Pune Police Commissioner directed mandals to restrict their sound systems to four top speakers and four bass systems. But despite the clear instructions, mandals flouted the norms. Officials said the mandals booked during the celebrations were found using sound systems beyond the permitted limits. "We registered cases against Dahi Handi mandals that violated the 65-decibel sound limit by using loudspeakers," Amrutkar said.

Prohibited systems seized

The police action was not limited to registering FIRs. Several sound systems used in violation of the restrictions were seized during the celebrations, including plasma speakers, pressure-mid systems and other equipment, officials said. The enforcement drive followed sustained monitoring of sound levels at celebration venues across the city by police teams. The readings were subsequently compiled, and cases were registered against organisers violating prescribed limits.

16 cases in Pimpri-Chinchwad

In Pimpri-Chinchwad, police registered 16 cases against Dahi Handi mandals and sound-system operators for playing music beyond permissible limits during celebrations on September 5. Music systems, loudspeakers, amplifiers and mixers were seized during the action.

Bavdhan police registered cases against three mandals in Mhalunge, Lavale and Bhugaon, while Nigdi police took action against four mandals. Pimpri, Sant Tukaramnagar, Dapodi, Hinjewadi, Bhosari, Dighi, Kalewadi, Chakan South and Wakad police stations each registered cases against one Dahi Handi mandal.

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Application Period: 09 September 2026 to 15 September 2026
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Eligible candidates are requested to complete the registration and admission process within the stipulated period.

For Admission Details & Registration:
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Date: 09.09.2026
Place: Pune



INFLATION FAILS TO DAMPEN FESTIVE SPIRIT

Rising prices of idols, sweets, mandaps and décor push up Ganeshotsav budgets, prompting devotees to rethink spending while welcoming Bappa with warmth



REVISED CALCULATIONS

- Small idols that cost Rs 1,500–2,000 last year are now priced at around Rs 3,000–3,500, buyers said.
- Khawa modak cost Rs 800–1,000 per kg, while Ukadiche modak are around Rs 45 apiece; sweet prices may rise further.
- Decoration and mandap costs have increased by 20–30%, with elaborate home décor packages ranging from Rs 20,000 to Rs 80,000.
- Families said five-day celebrations that cost Rs 15,000–20,000 last year could now reach Rs 25,000–30,000.
- Residents and mandap makers said rising material, labour, transport and flower costs are pushing families towards simpler décor and homemade sweets.

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Ganeshotsav preparations are already underway across Pune, but this year the festival is set to burn a bigger hole in household budgets. From idols and sweets to mandaps, home décor, and flowers, nearly every festival essential has become costlier than last year.

Pune Times Mirror spoke to sweet makers, decorators, mandap sellers and residents across the city to take stock of the rising cost of celebration. While businesses point to higher raw material, labour and transportation costs as the reason, residents say they are being forced to rethink how and how much they celebrate.

Sweet-makers flag further price rise

Sweet sellers are bracing for yet another round of price hikes as raw material costs continue to climb. "Khawa modak ranges between Rs 800 and Rs 1,000 per kg, and 'ukadiche' modak are being sold at Rs 45 apiece — prices are already higher than last year, and there's a chance of a further 30% increase in the coming days," said Mahendra Gadwe of Kaka Halwai Sweets, attributing the surge to rising milk, sugar and other raw material costs.

The pressure is being felt across the trade. "Milk prices have risen by around 16% in the past four months, while sugar prices have nearly doubled in some cases," said Mukta Godbole of Shri Krishna Sweets, near Dagdusheth Halwai Ganpati. Peda, she noted, now costs Rs 750–780 per kg, up from Rs 550–560 earlier, with prices across almost all sweets climbing by at least 30% on higher raw material and LPG costs.

Mandap makers feel the squeeze too

Décor isn't escaping the price surge either. "Mandaps made using sunboard sheets, artificial flowers and other decorative materials have become more expensive, with prices rising by around 20–30%," said a mandap maker from Raviwar Peth, requesting anonymity. He explained that decorators now use foam — a thermocol-like material permitted after the ban on actual thermocol — and that higher labour and material costs are being passed on to customers.

For many middle-class families, elaborate setups are simply slipping out of reach. "Prices have increased by around 20% compared to last year. Home décor packages now start at around Rs 20,000 and can go up to Rs 80,000, which is beyond the reach of many middle-class families. Most prefer setups in the Rs 5,000–10,000 range, but even basic décor, mandaps and flower decorations have become costlier," said Rajwardhan Patil, a mandap maker.



Citizens feel the pinch

With sugar, ghee and dry fruits all growing costlier, prasad and mithai are proving expensive too, pushing many households toward simpler alternatives. "Premium dry-fruit sweets have become quite expensive compared to previous years. Instead of distributing dry fruits, mithai and laddoos as before, we are keeping it simple and trying to make all the sweets at home," said Tushar Shinde, a Tilak Road resident.

The cumulative effect is hard to miss. "Almost every item has become expensive this year. The idol, mandap and sweets have all seen price hikes. Since we have guests visiting throughout the five days, we are trying to balance the celebrations without stretching our budget too much," said Sakshi Shinde, a Karve Nagar resident.

For families hosting elaborate home celebrations, the arithmetic has shifted sharply. "Our celebration cost us around Rs 15,000–20,000 last year, covering the idol, décor, prasad, lighting and visarjan. This year, the same celebrations are likely to cost around Rs 25,000 – 35,000," said Sai Wadkar, a Sinhagad Road resident.

Even the smallest idols haven't been spared. "A small idol that was available for Rs 1,500–2,000 earlier is now costing nearly Rs 3,000–3,500. Labour and transport charges have increased substantially, while eco-friendly Shadu clay idols add different costs," said Shreya Jadhav, a Sadashiv Peth resident.

Although the prices have gone up, the joy of Ganeshotsav remains undimmed. Devotees across the city are recalculating their budgets to give their beloved Bappa the warmest welcome they can.

BEYOND BAPPA

Tucked away in a narrow lane of Tulshibaug, the 79-year-old Mayuresh Mitra Mandal has built a reputation for turning its Ganeshotsav displays into engaging lessons on Marathi culture and history

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In the crowded lanes of Tulsibaug, tucked into a narrow street, sits a small Ganesh mandal that has earned a reputation far beyond its modest size. Named after Lord Ganesha himself, Mayuresh Mitra Mandal has become known across Maharashtra not for grandeur, but for ideas — its Ganeshotsav displays built around themes rather than scale.

Over the years, the mandal has brought to life the writings of Acharya Atre, the wit of Marathi humour, Pune's iconic signboards, and its deep-rooted love for the Marathi language through its decorations. Since 2010, it has anchored its celebrations around a dedicated movement centred on preserving and celebrating Marathi.

The mandal traces its roots back to 1947, born out of the joy and excitement that followed India's Independence. With Ganeshotsav falling soon after August 15 that year, locals in Mandewadi came together to form the mandal as a platform for collective celebration and community participation.

In recent years, the mandal has also built a beautiful permanent Ganesh temple, one its members speak of with particular pride, having raised it entirely through public participation and donations.

The idol of Mayuresh was crafted by sculptor Prakash Gosavi, who also creates the idols for Guruji Talim and Babu Genu mandals. The idol is known for its fine detailing and graceful appearance.

Awards and recognition

For Mayuresh Mitra Mandal, public education is the foundation behind every display. Its work has been noticed by several television channels, and its displays have secured top positions in competitions organised by various channels, as well as those conducted by Dagdusheth Halwai and the Pune Police.

In 2012, the mandal organised an exhibition showcasing the witty and distinctive 'Puneri patya' — Pune's famously sharp signboards. The exhibition received an overwhelming response. The following year, the mandal turned its attention to Marathi proverbs and 'ukhanas'.

Marathi graffiti, humorous anecdotes from Acharya Atre's books and 'vatratika' (witty, satirical, and humorous short poetry) by Suryakant Dolas have all found space in its displays. Last year, the mandal won the Pune Police's first prize for its presentation.

A festival that also serves society

The mandal's work does not end with its decorations. Every year, it serves food as prasad to Warkaris, distributes educational material to school students and organises health and blood donation camps with the participation of medical professionals. Since blood donation camps require financial support, political workers also lend in their support in organising them.

Such initiatives have continued year after year, becoming an integral part of the mandal's identity.

Even its immersion procession carries a social message. The approach has earned the mandal the Pune Police's award for the best immersion procession for three consecutive years.

Mayuresh Mitra Mandal is also the first mandal to participate in the immersion procession from Kumthekar Road. Only one troupe from the New English School participates in its procession. The mandal joins the procession at 11 am and aims to complete the immersion procession by 3 pm, keeping the duration to a minimum — an approach regarded as commendable.

The mandal has not used loudspeakers for many years. In fact, several mandals in the Tulshibaug area do not play Hindi songs either. Mayuresh Mitra Mandal has followed a tradition of celebrating Ganeshotsav in a purely religious manner for several years.

A new-generation mandal with an old purpose

Today, Ramesh Khaire leads the mandal, and his work has helped bring it recognition. Rather than creating massive, elaborate spectacles, the mandal focuses on decorations designed to cultivate an interest in reading among people.

His son Rahul Khaire, an engineer by profession, devotes time to oversee the creative work of the mandal. In many ways, it is a mandal that has adapted to the new generation while retaining its core purpose.

And every year, its distinctive approach draws large crowds eager to see what it has created.

'Ajab Punekaranche Gajab Maruti'

This year, Mayuresh Mitra Mandal's display explores 'Ajab Punekaranche Gajab Maruti', offering Punekars a glimpse of several Maruti temples that remain largely unknown to the public.

The old city is home to temples with unusual names such as Bhangya Maruti, Bandivan Maruti and Bhikardas Maruti. The display will trace these lesser-known shrines through information and photographs.

Historian Mandar Lavate has provided reference material and research support for the display.

Among the lesser-known Maruti temples being featured are Jodiya Maruti near the Bharat Itihas Sanshodhak Mandal in Sadashiv Peth; Kharkata Maruti in the premises of the Tulshibaug Ram Temple; Gophanya Maruti, established by the Chapekar brothers at the Faraskhana police station; and Lendya Maruti and Pavtya Maruti on Garud Ganpati Road.

For the many people who have come to Pune from outside the city, these unusual names are likely to be as intriguing as the stories behind the temples.



'WHEN SHIRISH PAI CALLED...'

Recalling a memorable incident, mandal president Rahul Khaire said, "We had once created a display based on the humour of Acharya Atre. I met Borkar, who organises exhibitions on Atre across Maharashtra, and shared all the information with him. Later, I received a call on my mobile from Atre's daughter, poet Shirish Pai.

"She appreciated our work and said, 'You have created a very good exhibition on Appa.' I initially did not understand whom she meant by 'Appa'. Later, I realised she was referring to Acharya Atre, and it felt wonderful.

"For workers like us, appreciation from such a great personality is itself a huge achievement."





SWEEPING LAPSES!

Scheme for clean roads falls flat within a month of taking off, agencies put on notice for shabby work

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The scheme was launched on a three-month experimental basis to boost the quality of sweeping across the city, and contractors were assigned the task

The Pune Municipal Corporation's much-touted 'performance-based sweeping' scheme to keep the city's roads clean and free of garbage has come under scrutiny within a month of its launch.

Inspections by civic officials found several stretches where sweeping had not been carried out, while garbage, dust, sludge and 'chronic spots' continued to remain along roadsides.

In some locations, sanitation workers were also found absent. Notices have consequently been issued to four contractual agencies, while M/s Priyank Enterprises has been fined Rs 5,000.

The PMC launched the scheme on a three-month experimental basis to improve the quality of sweeping across the city. From August 1, contractual agencies were assigned responsibility for daily sweeping within the jurisdiction of various ward offices. However, barely a month into implementation, shortcomings found during inspections have raised questions over the execution of the scheme itself.

M/s Priyank Enterprises is responsible for sweeping under the Yerwada-Wadgaon Sheri and Dhole Patil Road ward offices. On September 7, civic officials inspected five locations — Pune Airport Road, the area opposite the hot-mix plant, Wadgaon Sheri, the area opposite Shivaji Maharaj Udyan, and the stretch from Dr Babasaheb Ambedkar Chowk to Golf Club Chowk.

No sweeping had been carried out at any of the five locations. Garbage and 'chronic spots' were found, while sanitation workers were also absent. As sweeping had not been carried out in all five beats in violation of the SOP, the agency was fined ₹5,000.

Mechanical cleaning goes awry

Global Waste Management Cell Pvt Ltd has been assigned responsibility for mechanical sweeping of major roads in Zone III. A joint inspection conducted on September 2 found layers of garbage, plastic, dust and sludge accumulated on the footpaths, road edges, dividers and carriageways along Satara Road.

As the situation had not improved despite earlier instructions, the agency has been directed to submit an explanation within 24 hours. If the explanation is found unsatisfactory, the civic body has warned of penal recovery, forfeiture of the security deposit, cancellation of the contract and blacklisting of the agency.

The PMC has also sought GPS logs and records of 'broom-hours' for the mechanical sweeping operations.

Unsatisfactory work in Hadapsar-Manjari

M/s Sumit Facilities Limited is responsible for sweeping in various areas, including Hadapsar-Manjari. An inspection conducted on September 1 found the sweeping work in the vehicle parking area at Shewalewadi to be unsatisfactory. Meanwhile, garbage, 'chronic spots' and overgrown grass along roadsides were found on September 4 in Narhe, Dhayari and Nanded Phata, areas falling under the jurisdiction of M/s Siddhivinayak Enterprises.

While the PMC has entrusted contractual agencies with a major responsibility for keeping the city clean, the inspections have made it clear that the problem of unclean roads persists on the ground.

The findings have therefore raised questions not only over the performance of the contractors under the 'performance-based' sweeping scheme, but also over the efficiency of the civic machinery responsible for supervising their work.



पुणे महानगरपालिका, पुणे

निविदा प्रक्रिया कक्ष पाणीपुरवठा विभाग

निविदा जाहिरात - नविन कामे

विक्री कालावधी दिनांक : ०९/०९/२०२६ १८:०० दुपारी ते १६/०९/२०२६ १४:३० दुपारी पर्यंत
स्वीकृती दिनांक : ०९/०९/२०२६ १८:०० दुपारी ते १६/०९/२०२६ १४:३० दुपारी पर्यंत
तांत्रिक निविदा उघडणे प्रक्रिया दिनांक : १७/०९/२०२६ १५:०० दुपारी

निविदा क्रमांक	खात्याचे नाव	कामाचे नाव	निविदा संच किंमत रू.	अंदाजित पुर्व गणित रक्कम रू.	बयाणा रक्कम रू.	कामाची मुदत (महिने)	निविदा विषयक जबाबदार व्यक्तीचे नाव व दूरध्वनी क्रमांक
PMC_MAIN_WATER_SUPPLY_382	पाणीपुरवठा	प्र.क्र.२६ड मध्ये विविध ठिकाणी पिण्याच्या पाण्याची लाईन बदलणे व तदनुषंगिक कामे करणे	रु. ४१५/-	रु ८४७३३२/-	रु ८४७३/-	६	जाधव ०९७०१३८२३१
PMC_MAIN_WATER_SUPPLY_383	पाणीपुरवठा	प्रभाग.क्र. २७ क मध्ये, जुन्या बीर्ण झालेल्या पिण्याच्या पाण्याच्या लाईन बदलणे	रु. १३५९/-	रु २११८४१७/-	रु २११८४/-	६	पूनम बिडकर ८००७३६२०६५
PMC_MAIN_WATER_SUPPLY_384	पाणीपुरवठा	प्रभाग क्र. २७ क मध्ये, प्रभागातील जुन्या जीर्ण झालेल्या पिण्याच्या पाण्याच्या लाईन बदलणे	रु. १३५९/-	रु १६९४८७०/-	रु १६९४९/-	६	पूनम बिडकर ८००७३६२०६५
PMC_MAIN_WATER_SUPPLY_385	पाणीपुरवठा	कार्यकारी अभियंता क्र.२ अंतर्गत येणाऱ्या प्रभाग क्र. २७ मध्ये मोठ्या व्यासाच्या जलवाहिन्यांची दैनंदिन देखभाल दुरुस्ती कामे करणे.	रु. १३५९/-	रु ४२३६४३६/-	रु ४२३६४/-	६	पूनम बिडकर ८००७३६२०६५
PMC_MAIN_WATER_SUPPLY_386	पाणीपुरवठा	प्र.क्र. २७ड गवनि व वस्ती विभागात पाण्याची लाईन टाकणे	रु. ४१५/-	रु ८४७३८४/-	रु ८४७४/-	६	पूनम बिडकर ८००७३६२०६५
PMC_MAIN_WATER_SUPPLY_387	पाणीपुरवठा	प्र.क्र. २७ड झोपडपट्टी व विविध भागात पाण्याची लाईन टाकणे	रु. ४१५/-	रु ८४७३६०/-	रु ८४७४/-	६	पूनम बिडकर ८००७३६२०६५
PMC_MAIN_WATER_SUPPLY_388	पाणीपुरवठा	प्र.क्र. २७ड दत्तवाडी व आंबील ओढा येथे प्राण्याची लाईन टाकणे	रु. १३५९/-	रु २११८३९६/-	रु २११८४/-	६	पूनम बिडकर ८००७३६२०६५
PMC_MAIN_WATER_SUPPLY_389	पाणीपुरवठा	प्र.क्र. २७ अ मधील विविध ठिकाणी पिण्याच्या पाण्याची नवीन लाईन टाकणे	रु. १३५९/-	रू. १६९४६१५/-	रू. १६९४६/-	६	पूनम बिडकर ८००७३६२०६५
PMC_MAIN_WATER_SUPPLY_390	पाणीपुरवठा	प्र.क्र. २६ड मध्ये गुरुवार पेठ परिसरातील जैन मंदिर चौक, रविवार पेठ परिसर व विविध ठिकाणी येथील पिण्याच्या पाण्याची लाईन टाकणे व दुरुस्ती विषयक कामे करणे व तदनुषंगिक कामे करणे	रु. ४१५/-	रू. ८४७२५४/-	रू. ८४७३/-	६	जाधव ०९७०१३८२३१
PMC_MAIN_WATER_SUPPLY_391	पाणीपुरवठा	प्र.क्र. २६ ड मध्ये घोरपडे पेठ खडकमाळ आळी परिसरातील सार्वजनिक शौचालय तसेच पिण्याच्या पाण्याची लाईन दुरुस्त करणे व तदनुषंगिक कामे करणे	रु. ४१५/-	रू. ४२३६०३/-	रू. ४२३६/-	६	जाधव ०९७०१३८२३१
PMC_MAIN_WATER_SUPPLY_392	पाणीपुरवठा	प्रभाग क्र. २४अ मध्ये मंगळवार पेठ, कमवा पेठ व विविध ठिकाणी विविध व्यासाच्या पिण्याच्या पाण्याच्या लाईन दरुस्त करणे.	रु. ४१५/-	रू. ८४७०९३/-	रू. ८४७१/-	६	सागर तानाजीराव सिंगारे ७७७५०५४५५६
PMC_MAIN_WATER_SUPPLY_393	पाणीपुरवठा	प्रभाग क्र. २४अ मध्ये मोमवार पेठ, रास्ता पेठ, पदमजी पार्क येथे विविध व्यासाच्या पिण्याच्या पाण्याच्या लाईन दुरुस्त करणे.	रु. ४१५/-	८४७०३०/-	रू. ८४७०/-	६	सागर तानाजीराव सिंगारे ७७७५०५४५५६
PMC_MAIN_WATER_SUPPLY_394	पाणीपुरवठा	प्र.क्र. २३ व मधील नाना पेठ, गणेश पेठ, भवानी पेठ परिसरात पाण्याची लाईन टाकणे व तदनुषंगिक कामे करणे.	रु. ४१५/-	रू. ८४६९१४/-	रू. ८४६९/-	६	किरण देसले ९६८९९३८३०४
PMC_MAIN_WATER_SUPPLY_395	पाणीपुरवठा	प्र.क्र. २३ व मधील राजेवाडी, पत्रा चाळ, मंजुळाबाई चाळ, बुधवार पेठ परिसरात पाण्याची लाईन टाकणे व तदनुषंगिक कामे करणे	रु. ४१५/-	रू. ८४७३९२/-	रू. ८४७४/-	६	किरण देसले ९६८९९३८३०४
PMC_MAIN_WATER_SUPPLY_402	पाणीपुरवठा	प्र.क्र. २३ क मधील विविध ठिकाणी पाण्याची लाईन टाकणे व इतर तदनुषंगिक कामे करणे	रु. ४१५/-	रू. ८४७२१८/-	रू. ८४७२	६	किरण देसले ९६८९९३८३०४
PMC_MAIN_WATER_SUPPLY_403	पाणीपुरवठा	प्र.क्र. २३ ड, जुन्या पाण्याच्या लाईन दुरुस्त करणे	रु. ४१५/-	रू. ८४७२१८	रू. ८४७२	६	किरण देसले ९६८९९३८३०४
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अ) सदर कामाबाबत निविदा अटी/शर्ती इ. बाबतचा सर्व तपशिल निविदा संचामध्ये नमूद केला असून सदर कामांचे निविदा संच www.mahatenders.gov.in या वेबसाईटवर पाहण्यासाठी उपलब्ध आहे. निविदा संचाची विक्री व स्वीकृती सदर वेबसाईटवरून फक्त ऑनलाइन पद्धतीने करण्यात येत असून सर्व निविदा दोन पाकीट पद्धतीने मागविण्यात येत आहेत.

ब) निविदा प्रक्रियाच्या शेवटच्या दिवशी निविदा संच प्राप्त न झाल्यास स्वीकृतीच्या शेवटच्या दिवशी ऑनलाइन सादरीकरण न झाल्यास याची सर्वस्व जबाबदारी टेंडरदाराची राहील.

क) ऑनलाइन निविदा प्रक्रीयेबाबतची संपूर्ण माहिती टेंडर सेल विभाग पुणे म.न.पा. येथे मिळेल.

ड) कार्यालयीन आदेश क्र. अतिमआ (वि)/३२, दि.२२.०४.२०१६ नुसार बयाणा रक्कम ECS / RTGS / NEFT सुविधेमार्फतच स्वीकारण्यात येणार आहे.

सही/-
संकेत सुधाकर माने
टेंडर लिपिक
(पाणीपुरवठा)
पुणे महानगरपालिका

सही/-
सुनिल यादव
कार्यकारी अभियंता
(पाणीपुरवठा)
पुणे महानगरपालिका

जाहिरात क्रमांक : २/७४६ दि. ०८/०९/२०२६

Government of Maharashtra

Water Resources Department
Godavari Marathwada Irrigation Development Corporation, Chh. Sambhajinagar
Executive Engineer, Ahilyanagar Irrigation Division, Ahilyanagar, (Hq.Loni)
E-mail - eeaidn@gmail.com E-Tender notice no.05 2026-27 Phone no.- 0241-2324018

E-Tenders are invited from the persons owning/operating Hotels/Sites/Restaurants/Tent sites /Visitor Centre for RUNNING AND MANAGING (on Conducting Basis) the following property on "As is where is basis" on Short Term Lease Basis (Public Private Partnership (PPP) basis) of 49 years in Dist- Ahilyanagar.

Sr. No.	Name of Property	Property Details	Present Value of Property (Rs in Lakh)	One time Premium (Non-refundable) (Rs in Lakh)	Minimum Avg. Yearly Bid Value (Rs in lakh)	EMD (Rs in Lakh)	Annual Turnover (Not less than) (Rs in Lakh)	Period Years
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
1	Bhandardara Dam, Shendi Village Taluka-Akole	Area: 1.109 Ha. Lat: Shendi Village, S. No. 109 19°33'1.30"N Long: 73°45'34.86"E	38.82	0.73	0.49	1.5	29.11	49
2	Bhandardara Dam, Bhandardara Village Krushnavanti Rest House	Bhandardara Village Krushnavanti Rest House, S. No. 195 Area: 0.84 Ha. Lat: 19°32'44.37"N Long: 73°45'40.80"E	(Land value + Existing Rest house value) 29.4+48.45 =77.85 lakh	1.46	0.97	1.5	58.38	49

Interested bidders can download the complete and detailed BID Document from www.mahatenders.gov.in from Date 09/09/2026 to Date 29/09/2026
Opening of Technical Bid - Date 30/09/2026 (if possible)

Sd/-
(S.V.Kale)
Executive Engineer
Ahilyanagar Irrigation Division
Ahilyanagar (Hq.Loni)

क्रमांक : आरओसी-2026-27/क्र-5/C2699

GOVERNMENT OF MAHARASHTRA

Public Works Department

Department/Division	Executive Engineer, P.W. Division, Kolhapur
E-Tender Notice No.	Notice No. 41 For 2026-2027

Following works are invited by the Executive Engineer, Public Works Division, Kolhapur

1. All eligible/interested contractors who want to participate in tendering process should compulsory get enrolled on e-tendering portal "http://mahatenders.gov.in" and further need to empanelled. Tenders should be submitted online on above web site. This notice also available on www.mahapwd.com

2. For submission of online E-tenders, tenderers should have Class II / III Digital signature and they should get enrolled on above website for submission of E-tender. Any queries of online submission email id- support- eproc@nic.in & Telephone No. 0120-4200462, 0120-4001002

3 . All the payment towards EMD and cost of Tender forms will be done online only.

4. Contact details for clarification of any doubts regarding submission of E-tender "Executive Engineer, Public Works Division, Kolhapur Phone No. 0231-2651457.

Sr. No.	Name of work	Type of Tender	Estimated Cost (In Lakhs)	EMD	Tender Form Fee with GST	Work Completion Period	Class of Contractor
1	Improvements and Strengthening to Hasur Bk. Bolavai Thanewadi Avchitwadi Chimagaon Murugud Road MDR No.49 km 0/00 to 14/200 Tal-Kagal Dist. Kolhapur	B1	783.86	392000/-	4100/-	12 Months	PWD Registration not Required
2	Strengthning and Widening to Yevati Pati Bachani Sake Sawarde Choundal Road MDR 42 Km. 29/400 to 31/600 and 34/700 to 38/700 6.200 Km) Tal. Kagal Dist. Kolhapur	B1	343.06	172000/-	2720/-	12 Months	PWD Registration not Required

Tender Schedule

Sr. No.	Stage	Date and Time	
1	Publishing Date	09/09/2026	10.00 hrs.
2	Bid Submission Start Date	09/09/2026	10.00 hrs.
3	Pre-bid Meeting	11/09/2026	12.30 pm at Office of The Chief Engineer, P. W. Region, Pune
4	Bid Submission Closing Date	16/09/2026	at 18.00 hrs.
5	Submission of Hard Copy (Office Addresses)	18/09/2026	Office of the Executive Engineer, P.W. Dn, Kolhapur Executive Engineer, P.W. (South) Dn. Kolhapur Superintending Engineer, Kolhapur P.W. Circle, Address- Near Head Post office, Ramanmala Tarabai Park, Kolhapur-03 upto 11.00 hrs.
6	Bid Opening Date	18/09/2026	11.01 hrs. at Office of The Superintending Engineer, P.W. Circle, Kolhapur.

Correspondence Address
The Executive Engineer,
Public Works Division, Kolhapur
Near Ramanmala Head Post Office,
Tarabai Park, Kolhapur-416003
Tel-0231-2651457 Fax-0231-2654919
email- kolhapur.ee@mahapwd.gov.in

Sd/-
(Krantikumar P. Mirajkar)
Executive Engineer,
Public Works Division, Kolhapur

क्रमांक : आरओसी-2026-27/क्र-5/C2705

'WE STILL CAN'T COME TO TERMS'

Family of C-DAC scientist, who died of heart attack while running Satara Hill Half Marathon, are at a loss for words

Jigar Hindocha
jigar.hindocha@punemirror.com
@ThePuneMirror



Sanjay Kadam

> Sanjay came to run, and he ran so far that he never returned to us. That is how terrible this loss feels.
> — **Anil Kadam,** brother of the deceased

For Sanjay Shamrao Kadam, the retired senior computer scientist from C-DAC, running was more than a fitness routine. It was a passion he pursued with quiet determination for over a decade.

On Sunday, the 65-year-old came to Satara for the 'Satara Hill Half Marathon,' as he had done for years. But this time, he never made it back home.

Kadam, who continued working as a consultant after retirement, had been a regular participant in the Satara marathon for at least 10 years and practised running every day. He had hypertension, but his commitment to long-distance running remained undiminished.

While speaking with Pune Times Mirror on Monday, brother Anil Kadam said, "Sanjay came to run, and he ran so far that he never returned to us. That is how terrible this loss feels."

"We still can't come to terms," said Anil.

A cardiac arrest on a downhill stretch

Sanjay began the half marathon around 6.30 am on Sunday. At about 9.15 am, while negotiating a downhill stretch, he suddenly collapsed following a cardiac arrest. The incident was immediately noticed and medical assistance was provided to him.

According to Dr Pratap Gole, a member of the marathon's medical team, cardiologist Dr Riyaz Mujawar immediately began CPR. A cardiac ambulance was available at the spot, and Kadam was administered an intracardiac injection before being shifted to Pulse Superspeciality Hospital.

Around 10.25 am, cardiologist Dr Kaushik Patil performed an angioplasty.

Kadam initially stabilised, raising hopes among his family and the medical team. But the improvement was short-lived. Around 2 pm, he suffered another severe cardiac arrest, and this time he could not make it.

A gentle man, rarely angry

For Anil, who witnessed the frantic efforts to save his brother, the loss was difficult to comprehend. He remembered Kadam not as someone defined by his professional achievements or sporting record, but as a gentle, cheerful and approachable man.

"Sanjay was soft-spoken and extremely calm. Even when he argued with someone, he did it with a smile. We sometimes wondered whether he was capable of becoming angry," Anil said.

Kadam was the eldest of four siblings and came from Kadve Budruk, a remote village in Patan taluka. His father, a teacher, had overcome hardship to settle in Sangvi and establish an educational institution. Kadam became the first highly educated person from the region to become a scientist at C-DAC.

Through a C-DAC scholarship, he spent five or six years in London pursuing research before returning to India. His family, deeply rooted in education and public service, regarded his journey with immense pride.

"Sanjay was a star in our family who quietly continued to shine," Anil said.

The family's own 'Tanaji'

Sanjay Kadam was affectionately called "Tanaji" by his family, a childhood nickname given because he was talented and always inclined to do something different.

His passion for adventure was shared by his family. One brother has climbed around 160-170 forts, while another has undertaken cycling expeditions to Leh and Ladakh. For Sanjay, it was running.

His death has now left a large family of 50-60 members grieving across Pune, Mumbai, Satara and their native village. His mother, over 92 and on ventilator support at home, initially struggled to understand that her son had died.

The grief has spread beyond the family. Kadve Budruk in Patan taluka (Satara district) is mourning the loss of a son who had risen from a remote village to become a scientist, researcher and accomplished runner.

"Today, his absence is being felt not only by the family but by the entire village," Anil said.

Extortion allegations rock PCMC

Officials stalled building approvals to extract bribes from developers, alleges former BJP corporator; CM orders preliminary inquiry

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Serious allegations of financial extortion by allegedly corrupt officials in the Pimpri-Chinchwad Municipal Corporation's building permission department have come to light, with developers reportedly being deliberately harassed and forced to pay lakhs of rupees.

Taking serious cognisance of the allegations, Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis has directed the municipal commissioner to conduct a detailed inquiry and submit a report.

Former BJP corporator Tushar Hinge had submitted a written complaint directly to the Chief Minister, along with supporting 'evidence', alleging widespread corruption within the building department.

In his complaint, Hinge alleged that certain officials have been stationed in the municipal building department for several years and have built an entrenched network of corruption while working in the building control and permission wing, openly misusing their authority to financially exploit developers.

According to the complaint, files submitted to the building department for approval of plans for new buildings, occupancy certificates (OCs) and other permissions are allegedly kept pending for years. Some senior and junior officials in the department allegedly demand exorbitant amounts from developers to process the files according to rules and within the prescribed time. This has left developers who conduct their businesses honestly feeling helpless, the complaint states.



Chief Minister Fadnavis has ordered the municipal commissioner to conduct a preliminary inquiry. The municipal commissioner has been asked to submit a detailed report stating which files remained pending in the building department over the past few months, for how long they were pending and which officials raised objections on them

A deliberate system to extract bribes

According to the allegations, a set modus operandi is being followed to extract bribes from developers. Technical objections, minor deficiencies and errors are allegedly deliberately identified in files submitted for approval. Repeated objections are raised on files, forcing developers to make repeated visits to municipal offices. The complaint alleges that developers are subjected to sustained mental and financial pressure and ultimately forced to give in.

It further alleges that officials create unnecessary legal hurdles by seeking changes to the original layout of project sites, altering roads and raising issues related to sanctioned reservations. Developers are allegedly subjected to further mental and financial harassment in the process.

Former BJP corporator Tushar Hinge approached Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis over what he described as organised corruption in the civic body. He presented the Chief Minister with details of the alleged malpractice in the building department.

Hinge has demanded stringent action against officials allegedly hampering the city's development and tarnishing the administration's image, including action under the Maharashtra Control of Organised Crime Act (MCOCA) or the Prevention of Corruption Act through the Anti-Corruption Bureau (ACB).

Considering the scope and seriousness of the complaint, Chief Minister Fadnavis has ordered the municipal commissioner to conduct a preliminary inquiry. The commissioner has been asked to submit a detailed report stating which files remained pending in the building department over the past few months, for how long they were pending and which officials raised objections on them.

The Chief Minister's directive has reportedly caused considerable concern within municipal circles and among officials facing the allegations.

Alleged rate of ₹5-6 per sqft

In his complaint to the Chief Minister, Hinge has specifically mentioned the alleged rates involved in the bribery. According to the complaint, under the alleged unofficial system operating in the building department, 'malai' — a euphemism for bribes — of Rs 5 to Rs 6 per sqft is allegedly collected for every approval file.

The complaint alleges that not even a routine signature is given on a file unless the fixed amount is paid. Files allegedly do not move from officials' desks until the demanded bribe is paid.

Developers who refuse to pay or delay payment are allegedly subjected to deliberate delays in the approval process. Such delays can hold up housing projects, increase developers' bank interest costs running into crores of rupees and, ultimately, pass the financial burden on to ordinary homebuyers, the complaint alleges.

ADVERSE IMPACT ON REAL ESTATE SECTOR

Pimpri-Chinchwad is one of the country's rapidly expanding industrial and residential cities. However, allegations of open bribery in the building department are making it difficult for several major developers to invest in the city, the complaint alleges.

The alleged practices by a few civic officials have undermined the very concept of ease of doing business and dealt a major blow to the city's housing sector.

Following the Chief Minister's directive, all eyes are now on the municipal commissioner and the action taken in the matter. Whether officials found responsible are transferred to other departments or face direct suspension will become clear after the inquiry report is submitted.

Softer side of khaki

Woman police personnel plays mom, takes care of abandoned toddler at YCMH like her own child

Pune Mirror Bureau
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@ThePuneMirror

When an 18-month-old child was found alone and crying on Dehu's Bhandara Hill, there was no parent in sight. But at Yashwantrao Chavan Memorial (YCM) Hospital in Pimpri, the frightened toddler found comfort in the arms of a policewoman who stepped beyond her official duty to become a mother figure.

The innocent child, too young to call her or her parents' name or where she lives, was found wandering alone in the Bhandara Hill area by citizens. They searched the surrounding area for the child's parents and relatives for some time but could not find anyone. They subsequently alerted the police.



Police rushed to the spot, took custody of the child and admitted her to the YCM Hospital for first aid and safety. In the unfamiliar hospital environment, the toddler was initially terrified and kept crying.

It was then that Rani Raut, a woman police employee from the Pimpri-Chinchwad Police, stepped in to help.

The girl (in pic) found crying alone at Dehu's Bhandara Hill is now being cared for by policewoman Rani Raut at YCM Hospital as cops try to trace her parents

Instead of merely carrying out her official responsibility, Raut took personal charge of the child's care.

Motherly care

She has been looking after the toddler at YCMH as she would her own child — feeding her, gently patting her to sleep and ensuring that all necessary medical examinations are completed. The warmth and reassurance provided by the policewoman have gradually helped the child settle down.

The toddler now feels secure in her arms, while doctors, nurses and other hospital staff have also appreciated Raut's sensitivity and care.

For Raut, the uniform has not come in the way of showing a mother's affection to a child in distress. At a time when the toddler has no idea where her parents are, the policewoman has become the child's temporary source of safety and comfort.

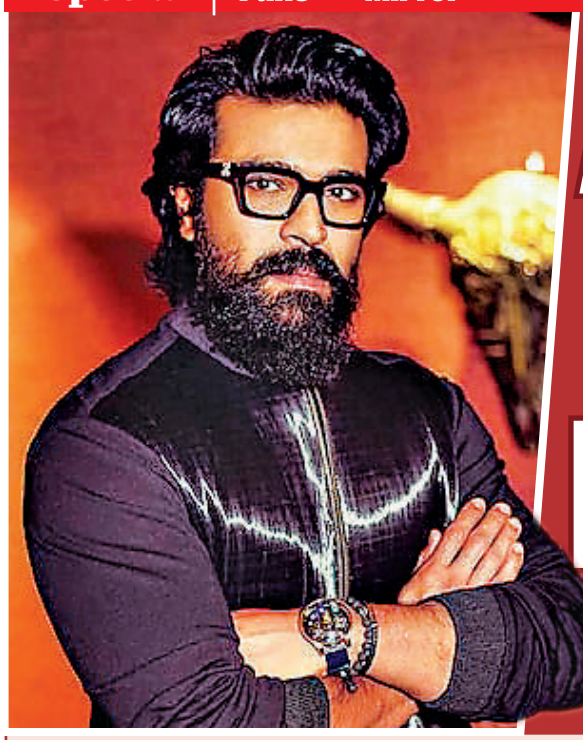
Search on for parents

Meanwhile, the police have begun a detailed investigation to trace the child's parents. Several questions remain unanswered: How did the toddler reach Bhandara Hill? Did the parents lose track of the child somewhere in the area, or was the child deliberately left there?

Police are investigating all possibilities. They are also checking police stations in Dehu and surrounding areas to find out whether any complaint regarding a missing child has been registered. Although the toddler is now safe, the temporary care at YCM cannot replace the child's own family. The immediate priority for the police is to trace the parents or relatives and reunite the child with them.

The Pimpri-Chinchwad Police and YCM Hospital administration have appealed to citizens for information. Anyone who knows anything about the child, her parents, relatives or home has been urged to immediately contact the nearest police station or YCM Hospital.

Until the child is reunited with their family, however, the little one has found an unexpected source of comfort — a policewoman who has put aside the uniform's official role and taken on the tenderness of a mother.



A MEETING TO REMEMBER

Japan's Biryani Man Serves Ram Charan, Says He Didn't Know the Star at First



For Japanese chef Takamasa Osawa, biryani is more than just a dish. It is a passion that has taken him across South Asia, earned him international recognition, and most recently, brought him into the home of Telugu superstar Ram Charan in Hyderabad.

Known as "Biriyani Osawa," the Japanese chef recently opened up about his memorable experience cooking for Ram Charan and his family. Interestingly, Osawa revealed that when he first received the opportunity, he was not fully aware of just how big a star Ram Charan was.

Cooking for a star

"Honestly, I didn't really know him at first," Osawa shared, adding that he later looked up the actor and watched RRR. That was when he realised that he was about to cook for a global star.

The special culinary experience took place at Ram Charan's residence in Jubilee Hills, Hyderabad, earlier this year. Dressed in his signature black chef's coat, Osawa prepared his much-loved biryani for the actor and his family.

For a chef who has spent years studying biryani, cooking in Hyderabad itself was a special moment. After all, the city is considered one of the world's most iconic biryani destinations. But serving the dish to Ram Charan and his father, veteran actor Chiranjeevi, made the experience even more unforgettable.

Osawa was reportedly introduced to Ram Charan through mutual friends. While he chose not to share further details about the meeting, he had plenty of good things to say about the actor.

Calling Ram Charan an "unbelievable gentleman", the chef recalled a simple gesture that left a lasting impression on him — the actor cleared Osawa's finished plate himself.

Videos and pictures from the visit had earlier gone viral on social media, giving fans a glimpse of the chef preparing biryani and interacting with the actor's family. Ram Charan was seen appreciating the dish for its flavour, aroma and balanced preparation, particularly noting that it was not overloaded with gravy.

The power of food

Osawa's journey with biryani is equally fascinating. His love affair with the iconic South Asian dish reportedly began during a trip to India when he was a young office worker. What started as curiosity eventually turned into a years-long mission to understand and perfect biryani.

Over the years, he travelled through India, Pakistan and Bangladesh, exploring different regional styles and cooking techniques. Today, his small Tokyo restaurant, Biriyani Osawa, is known for its singular focus on the dish and has received a Michelin Bib Gourmand recognition for its food.

From a Japanese office worker discovering biryani during a trip to India to cooking for one of Telugu cinema's biggest stars, Takamasa Osawa's journey is proof that food has the power to cross borders, cultures and even languages.

And for the chef, serving biryani in Hyderabad—to a family that loves the dish as much as Ram Charan's—was truly the icing on the cake.

THE COOKING CONTROVERSY

When Husbands Cook, Why Are Wives Still Judged?

In many Indian households, a husband cooking a meal is still seen as unusual. But strangely, the questions and taunts often land on his wife.

A man chopping vegetables, making rotis or preparing dinner for his family should be an ordinary sight in 2026. Yet, in many Indian homes, it continues to raise eyebrows. And more often than not, the wife ends up facing uncomfortable questions.

"Why isn't she cooking?"



"Does she not know how to cook?"

"Why does he have to do all the work?"

While conversations around equality and shared responsibilities have grown louder, the Indian kitchen remains one of the strongest spaces where traditional gender roles continue to exist.

A recent discussion around husbands cooking at home has once again highlighted this deep-rooted double standard. Even in urban households where both partners work, a man taking charge of the kitchen can still surprise relatives, neighbours and sometimes even domestic help. The situation often becomes more uncomfortable for the wife, who is judged for allowing her husband to cook.

The irony is hard to miss. Celebrity chefs are admired, celebrated and followed by millions. Men who cook professionally are seen as talented and successful. But when the same man enters his own kitchen to cook for his family, the reaction can suddenly change.

Instead of appreciating a shared responsibility, society often questions the woman.

For many wives, the judgement comes from unexpected places — relatives, friends, neighbours and even other women. Some are made to feel that they are failing as wives or mothers simply because their husbands enjoy cooking or willingly share household responsibilities.

The problem, however, is much bigger than cooking.

For generations, Indian women have been expected to manage not just the kitchen but also the invisible responsibilities that come with running a household. Planning meals, buying groceries, ensuring everyone eats on time, cleaning up and thinking about the nutritional needs of the family have largely been considered women's responsibilities.

Even today, when women have careers and contribute financially, household work is often viewed differently. A man helping in the kitchen is praised for being supportive. A woman doing the same work every day is simply expected to do it.

This is where the double standard begins.

A husband cooking dinner should not automatically mean that his wife is neglecting her responsibilities. Similarly, a wife cooking every day should not mean that household work belongs only to her.

Cooking is a life skill. More importantly, managing a home is a shared responsibility.

Interestingly, not every Indian household reacts negatively. Many couples today are breaking these stereotypes by dividing responsibilities based on interest, time and convenience rather than gender. In some homes, husbands enjoy cooking while wives handle other responsibilities. In others, the roles change depending on work schedules.

Perhaps that is what equality inside a home should actually look like — not a strict division of who is supposed to do what, but a partnership.

The next time a husband is seen preparing dinner while his wife relaxes after a long day, perhaps the question should not be, "Why is he cooking?"

Maybe it is time Indian households asked a simpler question: Why does it still surprise us?

DRI seizes gold worth ₹1.10 crore
— The Directorate of Revenue Intelligence (DRI), Mumbai Zonal Unit, busted a syndicate and seized 691.870 grams of 24-carat gold worth approximately Rs 1.10 crore, the agency said.

MPSC chief facing scrutiny?

Rohit Pawar seeks inquiry into Bhimanwar's career; warns of agitation if no action is taken in 3 days

NAGPUR
@ThePuneMirror

MLA Rohit Pawar has claimed that recurring questions are being raised regarding the examination process during Vivek Bhimanwar's tenure as Chairman of the Maharashtra Public Service Commission (MPSC). Pawar urged Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis to take the initiative in ordering an inquiry into Bhimanwar's civil service career to preserve students' trust in the commission.

Pawar stated that he intends to officially request detailed information—backed by evidence—regarding decisions taken by Bhimanwar during his term as RTO Commissioner, as well as various contracts awarded under his leadership. He further claimed that numerous letters were submitted against Bhimanwar on September 1, 2026.


Vivek Bhimanwar

Pawar argued that if allegations involving thousands of crores of rupees in corruption are circulating about Bhimanwar, they must be thoroughly investigated. He appealed to the chief minister to inspect the matter and assign a competent officer to lead the MPSC.

Pawar also raised concerns over the administration of MPSC examinations. Referencing the first recorded MPSC paper leak in 1997, he noted that allegations of paper leaks during the current chairman's tenure represent a serious issue.

He demanded that the chairman should accept moral responsibility and step down if it is proven that a paper was leaked under his watch. To clear doubts among students, Pawar urged the chief minister to intervene and appoint a capable candidate—citing officials like Tukaram Mundhe as an example—to restore credibility to the commission.

Three-day deadline set

Pawar asserted that he has formally raised objections regarding several MPSC examinations using supporting evidence, noting that concerns have been raised over the Group-B, Police Sub-Inspector (PSI), and Agriculture Department exams.

"If we do not receive a positive response within the next three days, protests will be launched in Pune and several other regions across the state. In Pune alone, 50,000 students will take to the streets," Pawar warned.

Concerns over leaked schemes

Pawar also questioned the marking pattern used for the Excise Department examination, explaining that prior knowledge of a marking scheme allows candidates to tailor their preparation and secure higher marks in less time. He warned that if such information leaked from within the MPSC, it constitutes a grave breach. Furthermore, Pawar expressed concern that practice irregularities—such as removing a candidate's name from the PSI examination list only to send them for training, or obtaining officer posts through financial bribery—could undermine the administration.

He demanded that the MPSC issue clear explanations if it denies these allegations, adding, "It is inappropriate to deny allegations initially, only to concede them later."

AGENCIES

MANOJ JARANGE ON FAST

'All issues addressed'

CM Fadnavis assures of open door policy for dialogue

#ANTARWALI SARATI
@ThePuneMirror

Manoj Jarange Patil's indefinite hunger strike demanding Maratha reservation and other measures entered its 11th day on Tuesday. When asked whether Jarange's demands had been met, Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis stated that all raised issues had been addressed, adding, "If they feel there are gaps or hold lingering doubts, they are welcome to raise them, and we will resolve them."

Fadnavis stated, "Whether it is the deputy chief minister or myself, our position is clear: whatever has been granted to the Maratha community to date was delivered by us. The decisions taken so far were made by us, and any future decisions will also be taken by us. Certain hurdles were addressed before decisions were finalised."

"The government has not merely issued orders on paper; the practical benefits are visible to the Maratha community. Everything permissible within the constitutional framework and subject to court rulings will certainly be done. We do not deprive one community to help another community. Our duty is to ensure justice for the Maratha community alongside all other groups," he clarified.

Fadnavis added that the government has not closed the door to dialogue regarding Jarange's protest. "The government always resolves issues through discussion, and steps are being taken in that direction," he said.

Late on Monday night, ministers including Prasad Lad and Uday Samant spoke to Jarange by telephone. Following the conversation, Jarange resumed the medical treatment he had previously paused, focusing attention on the forthcoming talks between the government and the protest leaders.


Manoj Jarange

Jarange criticises Vikhe Patil

Meanwhile, Manoj Jarange launched a sharp attack on Radhakrishna Vikhe Patil, Chairman of the Cabinet Sub-Committee on Maratha Reservation. "Vikhe Patil has caused the greatest harm to the Maratha community. He wasted an entire year by using sweet words," Jarange alleged.

Jarange claimed that Vikhe Patil had promised a decision on the Satara Sansthan Gazetteer within a month, yet a year has passed without fulfillment. He further accused the government of issuing empty assurances regarding certificates based on the Hyderabad Gazette without delivering results on the ground.

"Vikhe Patil should speak the truth now. His stance has damaged the community's interests," Jarange stated, further accusing Vikhe Patil of fulfilling Devendra Fadnavis's agenda.

AGENCIES

Trucks out, devotees in

Mumbai Goa highway clears the way for Ganpati Bappa!

Tushar Shete
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@ThePuneMirror

In a move that has brought cheer to millions of Ganesh devotees, the Maharashtra government has rolled out a massive relief plan for travellers heading to the Konkan region this festive season. The Transport Department has officially banned all heavy vehicles weighing 16 tonnes or more from plying on the Mumbai Goa National Highway 66 during the peak Ganeshotsav rush.

The decision comes after officials flagged a familiar festive nightmare, endless traffic snarls caused by trucks, trailers and sand carrying vehicles clogging the highway just when lakhs of ST buses and private vehicles are racing home for the celebrations.

Officials clarified that the ban is not meant to choke essential supplies but purely to give festive traffic a smooth run. Local police have also been handed flexible powers, with the Police Commissioner of Navi Mumbai and Superintendents of Police in the concerned districts allowed to relax restrictions based on ground reality.



The order is being seen as a huge sigh of relief for both Konkan residents and outstation devotees who annually dread the chaos of this stretch during Ganeshotsav. With buses, cars and two wheelers set to dominate the highway instead of towering trucks, this year's journey to Konkan may finally be jam free, stress free and full of festive cheer.

When the ban kicks in

- Idol arrival and prep travel: September 11, 2026 (00:01 hrs) to 15 September 2026 (23:00 hrs)
- Five day Ganpati immersion and return rush: September 18, 2026 (08:00 hrs to 23:00 hrs)
- Gauri Ganpati immersion (seven day): September 19, 2026 (08:00 hrs to 23:00 hrs) and September 20, 2026 (till 23:00 hrs)
- Anant Chaturdashi grand final immersion: September 25, 2026 (08:00 hrs) to September 26, 2026 (20:00 hrs)

Who gets a green signal

- Vehicles carrying import export cargo from JNPT and Jaigad ports
- Milk, petrol, diesel and cooking gas cylinder tankers
- Medicines, liquid oxygen and perishable goods including vegetables and food grains
- Ambulances, police vehicles, fire brigade and disaster management units
- Vehicles carrying material for the ongoing widening and repair work of the Mumbai Goa Highway, provided they carry a valid pass from traffic or highway police

HC rejects Rahul Gandhi's plea

Criminal defamation to move forward

#MUMBAI
@ThePuneMirror

The Bombay High Court on Tuesday rejected the plea filed by Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi, challenging a criminal defamation complaint over his alleged remarks against Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

Upholding the lower court's decision, a single bench of Justice N R Borkar stated that it found no 'perversity and illegality' in the order issued by the magistrate. Consequently, the criminal defamation proceedings against the Congress leader will move forward in the Girgaon Metropolitan Magistrate Court, requiring his personal appearance.

The legal matter stems from 2019, when the Girgaon Metropolitan Magistrate issued summons to Gandhi after concluding that a prima facie case of criminal defamation was established against him under Section 500 of the Indian Penal Code (IPC). Gandhi subsequently moved the High Court to quash the proceedings.

The complainant opposed Gandhi's petition before the High Court. Earlier in November 2021, the High Court had granted interim relief to the Congress leader by directing the magistrate court to defer the hearing, thereby exempting Gandhi from personal appearance until a final decision was reached on his petition. **ANI**



'PAYING THE PRICE OF WAR'

Turkish Prez slams Israel for derailing US-Iran MoU, sabotaging peace efforts

#ANKARA
@ThePuneMirror

Turkish President Recep Tayyip Erdogan on Monday accused Israel of sparking the West Asia conflict and intentionally sabotaging regional peace efforts, stating that the global economy and regional nations are paying the price for Israeli "schemes and provocations".

According to a statement published by his office on X, Erdoğan levelled sharp criticism against Israel's leadership, holding them directly responsible for derailing the 14-point Islamabad Memorandum of Understanding signed between Iran and the US in June, intended to bring relief and ease military tensions.

"Not just the Iranian people and our brotherly Gulf countries, but everyone, whether directly involved or not, is paying the price of the war that started with Israel's schemes and provocations," Erdogan said after a Presidential Cabinet meeting.

Highlighting diplomatic setbacks, Erdogan asserted that Israeli actions actively undermined agreements aimed at de-escalating conflicts involving Iran, the United States, and regional actors.



Smoke rises in southern Lebanon following Israeli strike as seen from Marjayoun on Monday, Sept 7
REUTERS/KARAMALLAH DAHER

"It was, once again, Israel's lies and acts of sabotage that derailed the Islamabad Accord, which had brought relief to our entire region," Erdoğan stated.

Warning that long-term regional stability remains out of reach as long as current hardline policies persist, the Turkish leader called for an immediate shift in approach toward diplomacy.

"As long as this radical mentality that regards even the slightest prospect of peace as a threat to itself remains unchanged, the 'storm of crisis' in our region will not subside," Erdoğan added.

Netanyahu firm on Iran 'regime' change

On the other hand, Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said that the Iranian government's downfall is approaching while it struggles for survival, adding that a further objective remains to be fulfilled.

During a governmental meeting held for a Rosh Hashanah Toast on Sunday, he made these observations.

"We are determined to defend ourselves; we are determined to strike our enemies. They are not attacking us. Iran is refraining from doing so, and it knows why. Of course, it could err and make the mistake of attacking us anyway. It will suffer a blow it cannot even imagine," the Israeli Prime Minister's Office quoted him as saying.

He maintained that Israel stands as the premier superpower across West Asia while issuing a caution to adversaries: "Do not try us."

"I say to our enemies: Do not try us. This (Israeli) people know how to unite in moments of testing, and right now it is the strongest superpower in West Asia, and some say even beyond," Netanyahu added.

"The achievements are immense, but there is still more to complete. I mean, first and foremost, the toppling of the (Iranian) regime. This regime in Iran — its end is near. It is weak, it is fighting for its life, it is faltering. And there is another mission to complete, which we are determined to bring about," Netanyahu highlighted.

AGENCIES

US steps up blockade

Iran threatens Gulf exclusion zone as US redirects 94 ships

#WASHINGTON
@ThePuneMirror

US Central Command forces operating in the Arabian Sea on Monday (local time) redirected nearly 100 commercial vessels and boarded multiple ships, stepping up the maritime blockade against Iran amid fresh threats of a "recalibrated" military posture from Tehran.

In a post on X, the US CENTCOM detailed the operational metrics of its naval blockade enforcement, accompanied by images of night carrier strike group sorties.

"An E/A-18G aircraft launches from the flight deck of USS George H.W. Bush (CVN 77) during night flight operations while the ship supports enforcement of the U.S. blockade against Iran in the Arabian Sea," CENTCOM posted. "As of Sept. 7, CENTCOM forces have redirected 94 commercial vessels, disabled 3 and boarded 2 to ensure complete compliance with the blockade."

Meanwhile, Iran's Supreme National Security Council Secretary Mohsen Rezaei warned Washington that Tehran has "fundamentally recalibrated" its military operational posture toward US warships and bases, threatening to establish a maritime exclusion zone across the Persian Gulf in response to American economic sanctions.

In a post on X, he stated that recent Iranian missile tests served as a direct warning to the US. "In recent days, Washington has received a clear warning from Iran's new missiles," Rezaei posted. "Economic warfare will be met by a maritime exclusion zone across the Persian Gulf to the blockade perimeter. The operational posture toward U.S. warships and bases has been fundamentally recalibrated."

Earlier in the day, Rezaei said Tehran will keep the Strait of Hormuz open if the United States stops threatening or attacking Iran.

In an interview with Iranian state broadcaster Islamic Republic of Iran Broadcasting (IRIB) on Sunday, Rezaei said Iran's position on the strategic waterway was directly linked to Washington's military posture towards Tehran.

"Iran will commit to keeping the Strait of Hormuz open when the US neither threatens nor attacks Iran," Rezaei told IRIB.

AGENCIES

Saudi energy infra hit

70 injured in Houthi attack; ops suspended

#RIYADH
@ThePuneMirror

Saudi Arabia's Energy Ministry stated that multiple energy facilities and installations located within the southern province of the kingdom came under attack on Tuesday morning, reportedly leaving around 70 people injured.

A formal statement released on X detailed that the hostile incidents triggered fires across various locations and caused a brief suspension of select operations, while official emergency teams rushed to ensure personnel safety, protect infrastructure, and restore normal workflow continuity.

The ministry further noted that comprehensive evaluations of the structural damage are currently underway, adding that all individuals who sustained injuries are receiving proper medical care.

These strikes formed part of an assault by Yemen's Iran-backed Houthi movement, prompting the Saudi-led coalition in Yemen to announce on Tuesday a firm response to the latest outbreak of hostilities.



Indian Navy's guided missile destroyer INS Visakhapatnam deployed in the Gulf of Aden responded to a distress call from MV Merlin Luanda after it caught fire due to a suspected drone strike by Houthi rebels in Yemen ANI FILE PHOTO

The Houthis, who control the most populous parts of Yemen and much of the north, have been launching attacks towards Saudi Arabia since declaring a naval blockade against Riyadh in July, with strikes targeting its vessels in the Red Sea.

Characterising the escalation as dangerous, the spokesperson for the Saudi-led coalition in Yemen stated on Tuesday that the insurgent faction deliberately targeted civilian and economic entities in the world's largest oil exporter and de facto OPEC leader.

Colonel Turki al-Malki emphasised in a formal statement published on X, "The coalition will take all necessary operational measures to deter this terrorist militia and resolutely confront its hostile approach." The official briefing added that the coordinated Houthi operations struck targets situated within the cities of Abha, Khamis Mushait, Jazan, and Najran.

Furthermore, a report published on Monday by the Financial Times indicated that Aramco's Jazan oil facilities were hit in new strikes, with damage assessments currently in progress.

AGENCIES

HEALTH TIP: Antibiotics are powerful medications used to treat and fight bacterial infec tions by killing bacteria or stopping them from growing.



Taking antibiotics unnecessarily or incorrectly causes bacteria to adapt, creating drug-resistant 'superbugs' that are hard to treat.

Pune Times Mirror | 14
Wednesday, September 9, 2026
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ASK THE SEXPERT



DR ROHAN JAHAGIRDAR
Psychiatrist & Sexpert

1 I am a 34-year-old man. I have great sex only on the right side of my bed and whenever I have it on the left side I face issues with my performance. What should I do?
Dear Sir, you need to go see a doctor and check yourself for OCD. Until then, you can continue having sex on the side where you can perform. Sexual disorders do not occur based on which side of the bed you are having sex. Hope you get that RIGHT!

2 I am a 45-year-old female. I have been suffering with hypothyroidism for sometime. I feel my drive has gone down and I have become a little irritable. Can that happen?
Ma'am,Yes the hypothyroidism can directly affect the sexual drive and should improve as you get treated. However, given your age also consult a doctor for symptoms of menopause which can also have an impact on your mood and sexual life.

3 I am a 19-year-old male. I had bought a pack of condoms six months back. I haven't got a chance to use them. How long can they remain unused?
My friend please check the expiry date on the packet! They can remain effective and safe with proper storage for upto 3 years, however, I sincerely hope that you don't have to wait that long!

4 I am a 29-year-old female. My boyfriend is extremely sensitive and emotional. Even if I talk about any other guy he gets insecure and starts comparing, when we have sex he takes a lot of time to open and put on a condom and that sometimes annoys me. How do I communicate that to him without hurting him?
Dear Ma'am, you can help him in the process of putting on the condom. That will make the act more sensual and since he is sensitive you will hence not hurt his feelings. However, you need to understand your boyfriend might have anxiety issues and you will need to address them eventually!

SEND YOUR QUERIES RELATED TO SEXUAL PROBLEMS TO
sexpert@punemirror.com



MINUTE SHARDS ARE BIG WORRY!

'Bacteria exposed to microplastic getting resistant to antibiotics'

In a startling discovery, a team of Boston University researchers found that bacteria exposed to microplastics became resistant to multiple types of antibiotics commonly used to treat infections.

Microplastics -- tiny shards of plastic debris -- are all over the planet. They have made their way up food chains, accumulated in oceans, clustered in clouds and on mountains, and been found inside our bodies at alarming rates.

Scientists have been racing to uncover the unforeseen impacts of so much plastic in and around us.

One possible, and surprising, consequence: more drug-resistant bacteria.

They say this is especially concerning for people in high-density, impoverished areas like refugee settlements, where discarded plastic piles up and bacterial infections spread easily.

The study is published in Applied and Environmental Microbiology.

"The fact that there are microplastics all around us, and even more so in impoverished places where sanitation may be limited, is a striking part of this observation," says Muhammad Zaman, a Boston University College of Engineering professor of biomedical engineering who studies antimicrobial resistance and refugee and migrant health.

"There is certainly a concern that this could present a higher risk in communities that are disadvantaged, and only underscores the need for more vigilance and a deeper insight into [microplastic and bacterial] interactions."

It's estimated that there are 4.95 million deaths associated with antimicrobial-resistant infections each year. Bacteria become resistant to antibiotics for many different reasons, including the misuse and overprescribing of medications, but a huge factor that fuels resistance is the microenvironment -- the immediate surroundings of a microbe -- where bacteria and viruses replicate.

At Boston University (BU), researchers rigorously tested how a common bacteria, Escherichia coli (E. coli), reacted to being in a closed environment with microplastics.

"The plastics provide a surface that the bacteria attach to and colonize," says Neila Gross (ENG'27), a BU PhD candidate in materials science and engineering and lead author of the study.

Once attached to any surface, bacteria create a biofilm -- a sticky substance that acts like a shield, protecting the bacteria from invaders and keeping them affixed securely.

Even though bacteria can grow biofilms on any surface, Gross observed that the microplastic supercharged the bacterial biofilms so much that when antibiotics were added to the mix, the medicine was unable to penetrate the shield.

"We found that the biofilms on microplastics, compared to other surfaces like glass, are much stronger and thicker, like a house with a ton of insulation," Gross says. "It was staggering to see."

The rate of antibiotic resistance on the microplastic was so high compared to other materials, that she performed the experiments multiple times, testing different combinations of antibiotics and types of plastic material.

Each time, the results remained consistent. Gross and Zaman say that the next step in their research is to figure out if their findings in the lab translate to the outside world.

How Antibiotics Work

- **Targeting Bacteria:** They disrupt bacterial cell walls or stop protein production, leaving human cells unharmed
- **Bacterial vs. Viral:** They only treat bacterial infections like strep throat or urinary tract infections. They do not work on viral illnesses like colds, the flu, or most coughs

Common Types

- **Penicillins:** Includes amoxicillin and penicillin for ear, sinus, and skin infections
- **Macrolides:** Includes azithromycin and erythromycin for respiratory and skin issues
- **Tetracyclines:** Includes doxycycline for acne and tick-borne illnesses
- **Fluoroquinolones:** Includes ciprofloxacin for serious urinary or respiratory tracts infections

Safe Usage, Resistance

- **Complete the Course:** Always finish the entire prescription, even if you feel better, so the infection does not return
- **Prevent Resistance:** Taking antibiotics unnecessarily or incorrectly causes bacteria to adapt, creating drug-resistant 'superbugs that are hard to treat
- **Side Effects:** Common reactions include nausea, upset stomach, or diarrhoea

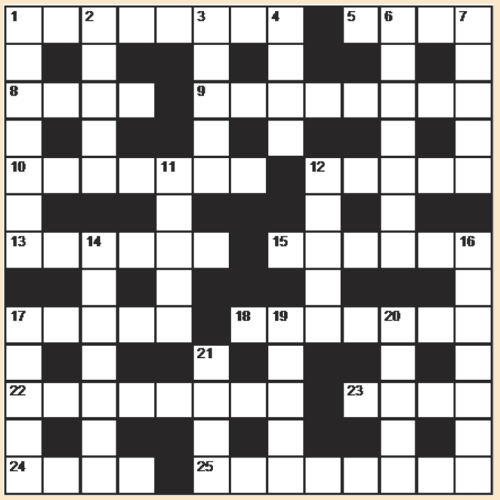


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QUICK 6688



ACROSS
1 Terms of endearment (3,5)
5 Pay attention to (4)
8 Take it easy (4)
9 Salad vegetable (8)
10 Plod wearily (7)
12 Find fault with (5)
13 Officers in training? (6)
15 Ski race (6)
17 Breezy (5)
18 Utter while crying (7)
22 Seaport in east China (8)
23 Word with Malshej or Western (4)
24 Mark of servitude (4)
25 Nonsense verse (8)

DOWN
1 Pertaining to fever (7)
2 Puccini opera (5)
3 Old spiked clubs (5)
4 Of like kind (4)
6 To involve others in perplexity (7)
7 Bo ____ : No. 10 heroine? (5)
11 Terse, condensed and forcible (5)
12 Himachal Pradesh's ___ Valley (5)
14 Copenhagen is its capital (7)
16 Of marriage (7)
17 Wishy – ___ : feeble in quality or character? (5)
19 Don't take it ___ down : stand up to it? (5)
20 Patna locale (5)
21 Small tool-store (4)

FOR ANSWER SCAN ↓

Please send copies of your children's artworks along with a photo of the artist in A4 size.
Do mention their age and the name of the school they attend. You can also mail us unpublished poems by children.





Kaira Gautam Nathani, 7 years, Alphonsa High, School





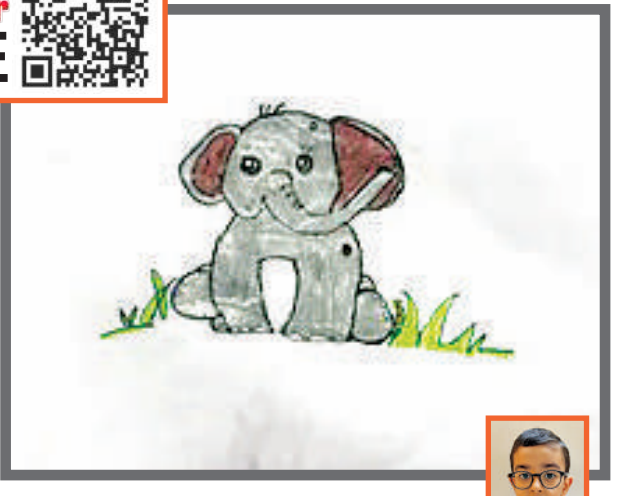
Krisha Kiran Soniwal, 8 years, Hutchings High School, Pune

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Rasagnya Rallabhandi, 7 years, Indo Scots Global School, Wagholi





Samar Chugh, 6 years, The Bishop's School, Kalyani Nagar

WHAT YOUR STARS SAY TODAY

Aries
March 21 - April 20

The rush around you is dizzying... Take a moment to center yourself in calm. You need to shield yourself from the surrounding commotion so you can find your footing again and feel steady.

Taurus
April 21 - May 20

You'll need to slow down your frantic pace. Do it without guilt—before you burn out. Your diet is nudging you toward imbalances, so it's a good idea to take a clear, honest look at your eating habits.

Gemini
May 21 - June 21

You'll need to slow down your frantic pace. Do it without guilt—before you burn out. Your diet is nudging you toward imbalances, so it's a good idea to take a clear, honest look at your eating habits.

Cancer
June 22 - July 23

A family influence is throwing a wrench into your day-to-day life today. Whether it's rooted in the past or not, it's still very much at work. Take a moment to question it—so you can reconnect with your own values, free from those outside influences.

Leo
July 24 – August 23

You're finally going to feel the positive results of everything you put in last month. Great joys are on the horizon. You can breathe out, relax, and give more time to the people you love. Make the most of it—plan a warm, friendly evening with the ones who matter to you.

Virgo
August 24 - September 23

Today, you'll assert yourself with ease and feel more open to constructive conversations. You'll feel truly understood and supported—so it's an ideal day to negotiate and get what you want!

Libra
September 24 - October 22

Because you're so naturally sociable, you can count on your friendships—and new people you'll meet—to bring easy, enjoyable conversations and plenty of bright moments. Today's energy is all about feeling relaxed and in a festive mood. Let it help you step out of your usual routine.

Scorpio
October 23 - November 22

You have a real gift for drawing favors to you. Your charm opens every door. You move with a calm, measured grace—almost instinctively. Don't try to rush the rhythm. Your energy stays steadily positive.

Sagittarius
November 23 - December 22

It's a highly active day—and it can be surprisingly profitable too. If you find yourself in an argument with someone, pause for a moment and ask whether you're fighting for a path that just doesn't fit you.

Capricorn
December 23 - January 20

Your optimism and confidence will earn you the admiration of everyone around you. No one can resist you today! Keep following your path with optimism—but don't forget to watch your diet to stay in balance.

Aquarius
January 21 - February 19

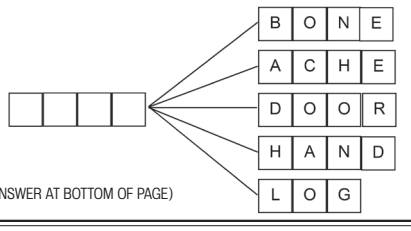
You need to have fun and break out of your routine. That's what will give your relationships a second wind. If you deny this truth, your frustration will only grow stronger today.

Pisces
February 20 - March 20

Your optimism is rising, and it helps you spot the bright side of everything. Good news is on the way—just don't push it too far. Put your energy where it matters, and avoid spreading yourself thin.

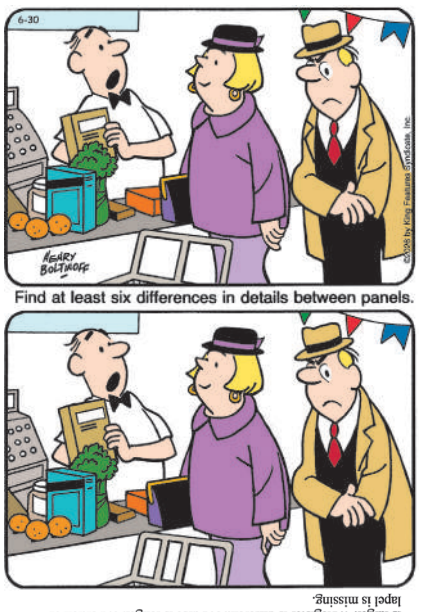
DOUBLE - BARRELLED

What word can be placed in front of the five words shown to form in each case another word ?



(ANSWER AT BOTTOM OF PAGE)

HOCUSFOCUS



Find at least six differences in details between panels.

Differences: 1. Cart handle is different. 2. Finger is moved. 3. Box is larger. 4. Register is different. 5. Purse is longer. 6. Portion of lapel is missing.

ANSWER FOR DOUBLE-BARRELLED : Back

Published by Mr. Parmeshwar Kawale for Lexicon Media Private Limited at S No 46/5, Aganagar Cooperative Housing Society Limited, Pune 411014 and Printed at- Shri. Chhatrapati Press, S.No. 53, Pune-Satara road, Katraj- Pune, Dist- Pune, State- Maharashtra. Editor (Pune): Priyanka Sharma, responsible for selection of news under PRB Act. © All rights reserved. Reproduction of whole or in part without written permission is prohibited.

'Agar Pancham hota, woh tum par fakhar karta'

The world of Indian music has witnessed many iconic collaborations, but some bonds go far beyond recording studios and hit songs. One such special relationship was shared between legendary singer Asha Bhosle and musician-singer Adnan Sami.

On what would have been Asha Bhosle's 93rd birth anniversary on September 8, a heartwarming memory of her appreciation for Adnan Sami has once again brought the two musicians' beautiful association into the spotlight. Asha Bhosle had once told Adnan that, after her late husband and legendary composer R.D. Burman, popularly known as Pancham, he was the one who understood and used her voice in the best possible way.





Her compliment carried even more emotional weight when she reportedly told him, "Agar Pancham hota toh woh tum par fakhar karta" — meaning that if Pancham had been alive, he would have been proud of Adnan.

For any musician, receiving appreciation from Asha Bhosle would be special. But being compared to the musical understanding of R.D. Burman was undoubtedly one of the biggest compliments Adnan Sami could receive.

Adnan's admiration for Asha Bhosle and R.D. Burman also goes back to his childhood. He has spoken about being fascinated by both legends from a young age and even recalled watching them perform in London. His admiration eventually turned into a close musical and personal association with Asha Bhosle.

The connection between Asha and Adnan was rooted in their shared love for experimentation and music that went beyond conventional boundaries. Asha Bhosle herself was known for constantly reinventing her sound. From energetic cabaret numbers and romantic melodies to classical compositions and ghazals, her voice could effortlessly adapt to different styles. Her collaborations with R.D. Burman remain among the most celebrated partnerships in the history of Hindi film music.

R.D. Burman had an extraordinary understanding of Asha's voice and pushed her to explore new sounds, rhythms and expressions. Songs like Aaja Aaja, Piya Tu Ab Toh Aaja, Dum Maro Dum and Chura Liya Hai Tumne became timeless examples of their creative chemistry.

Perhaps that is why Asha's words to Adnan Sami meant so much. She saw in him a musician who understood the many shades and possibilities of her voice.

As fans remember Asha Bhosle and her extraordinary musical journey, this emotional anecdote also highlights another beautiful part of her legacy — her ability to recognise, encourage and support talent. And for Adnan Sami, her words remain a musical honour that few artists could ever hope to receive.

Some compliments win awards. Others become a lifetime memory. And this one, coming from Asha Bhosle, was undoubtedly priceless.

Nora Fatehi faces defamation suit

Bollywood actor and dancer Nora Fatehi has landed in legal trouble after an aviation company filed a Rs 3-crore civil defamation suit against her over her social media comments about a chartered aircraft.

Dunes Aviation has approached a Gandhinagar court, alleging that Nora Fatehi's remarks about one of its aircraft caused serious damage to the company's reputation and business. The actor had reportedly described the aircraft as a "miniature", a "toy" and a "Lego airplane" in videos shared on her social media account.

According to reports, the incident dates back to December last year when Nora was travelling from Mumbai to Jaipur in a Cessna Citation CJ2 aircraft. During the journey, she recorded videos from inside the chartered plane and later posted them on Instagram.



However, what may have appeared to be a casual social media comment has now turned into a major legal dispute.

Dunes Aviation has alleged that Nora's comments were "derogatory and reckless" and negatively affected its commercial operations. The aviation company has reportedly claimed that the actor's remarks led to cancellations and a decline in bookings.

The company has alleged that bookings dropped by around 15 to 20 per cent following Nora's social media posts. It has also pointed out that Nora's massive social media following amplified the impact of her comments and allegedly resulted in reputational damage and loss of goodwill.

Apart from seeking Rs 3 crore in damages, Dunes Aviation has also reportedly requested the court to direct the removal of social media content containing references to the aircraft. The company has additionally sought a public clarification from her.

Defending the aircraft, Dunes Aviation has maintained that the plane was standard and appropriately sized for the Mumbai-Jaipur journey. The company has further stated that the aircraft was DGCA-certified, airworthy and lawfully operated under a valid Non-Scheduled Operator's Permit.

The suit was reportedly filed earlier this year and the matter is scheduled to be heard by Senior Civil Judge R Agarwal on September 25. The development has once again sparked conversations around celebrity influence and social media responsibility. With celebrities commanding millions of followers, even casual comments or humorous observations can quickly reach a massive audience and potentially impact brands and businesses.

Apoorva Mukhija breaks silence on NYU admission rumours

Social media influencer and content creator Apoorva Mukhija, popularly known as 'The Rebel Kid', has finally addressed claims that she allegedly paid a donation to secure admission to New York University's Stern School of Business.

Apoorva, who recently moved to New York to pursue her master's degree, found herself at the centre of an online debate after social media users questioned how she secured admission to the prestigious business school. Some posts even claimed that she had donated money to get her seat at NYU.

Now, the influencer has hit back at the allegations in her latest YouTube Storytime video, making it clear that her admission was based on her academic achievements, professional experience and interview performance — and not a donation.

Reacting to the speculation, Apoorva reportedly questioned why people believed she needed to "buy" her way into business school. She said she did not have the kind of money people were claiming she had donated and jokingly added that the university fees themselves felt expensive enough.



The content creator went on to highlight her academic background and years of professional experience. According to Apoorva, she has worked with some of the top brands in India and built a successful digital career over the past five years.

Apoorva pointed towards the business she has created through social media. With millions of followers and subscribers across Instagram and YouTube, she said her content creation journey has grown into a business with employees and a dedicated team working with her.

She also mentioned her experience in reality TV and acting while explaining why she believed she was a strong candidate for a business school programme. Confidently defending herself, Apoorva said that her communication and interview skills have always been among her strengths. The Rebel Kid's decision to move to New York has itself generated plenty of discussion online.